

しょくじ かいじょ
食事の 介助

Meal Assistance — Scenario Dialogue

Can-do: Announce mealtime, describe the food, encourage a resident to eat safely, and watch for choking.

1・Dialogue & Why — 会話

Hana
(caregiver)たなか ひる じかん
田中さん、お昼ごはんの 時間ですよ。

Tanaka-san, it's lunchtime.

Why: お昼[ひる]ごはん = 'lunch' — the お is a polite prefix that softens everyday nouns (you'll hear お茶[ちゃ], お水[みず], お food words all day in care). ～ですよ gently informs the resident. Always announce with their name so they orient to what's happening.

Tanaka-san
(resident)

ああ、もう そんな 時間ですか。

Oh, is it that time already?

Why: もう = 'already'; そんな時間[じかん] = 'that (kind of) time'. A natural, mild surprise. Notice residents often keep ～ですか (polite question) even when relaxed — don't worry about matching them exactly; you always stay polite.

Hana
(caregiver)きょう さかな
今日は お魚ですよ。

Today it's fish.

Why: Telling the resident the menu (お魚[さかな] = fish, with polite お) helps their appetite and orients them to the moment — a small but caring habit. 今日[きょう]は = 'as for today', marking the topic with は.

Tanaka-san
(resident)

おいしそうですね。

It looks delicious.

Why: おいしそう = 'looks delicious'. Attach ～そう to an adjective stem (おいしい → おいし + そう) to say something *looks/seems* a certain way from appearance. The ね invites agreement.

Hana
(caregiver)

ゆっくり 召し上がってください。

Please take your time and enjoy your meal.

Why: 召[め]し上[あ]がる is the HONORIFIC (尊敬語[そんけいご]) verb for 食[た]べる/飲[の]む ('to eat/drink'). Using an honorific for the RESIDENT's action raises them respectfully — exactly right in care. 召[め]し上[あ]がってください = 'please eat'. ゆっくり ('slowly') keeps them safe and unhurried.

Tanaka-san
(resident)

いただきます。

仕事日本語・Shigoto Nihongo

Thank you for the meal. (said before eating)

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Why: いただきます is the fixed phrase said before eating — literally a humble 'I receive', expressing gratitude for the food. Everyone says it; encourage residents to as well. (After eating: ごちそうさまでした.)

Hana
(caregiver)

お茶^{ちゃ}も どうぞ。むせないように 気^きをつけてくださいね。

Here's some tea too. Please be careful not to choke.

Why: どうぞ = 'here you are / please go ahead' when offering something. The key care phrase: むせる = 'to choke/cough on'; ~ないように = 'so as NOT to ~'; 気[き]をつけてください = 'please be careful'. Watching for choking (誤嚥[ごえん] aspiration) is one of a caregiver's most important safety duties.

Tanaka-san
(resident)

ありがとう。

Thank you.

Why: Casual ありがとう from the resident. You would reply with the fuller ありがとうございます — the one-way politeness of care again.

Hana
(caregiver)

何^{なに}か 手伝^{てつだ}いましょうか。

Shall I help you with anything?

Why: 何[なに]か = 'something / anything'. 手伝[てつだ]いましょうか uses ~ましょうか = 'shall I ~?' to OFFER to do something for them — polite and non-pushy. Offer help, but let them keep their independence (自立支援[じりつしえん]).

Tanaka-san
(resident)

だいじょうぶ 自分^{じぶん}で 食^たべられます。

I'm okay. I can eat by myself.

Why: 自分[じぶん]で = 'by myself'; 食[た]べられます is the potential form of 食[た]べる ('can eat'). A resident asserting independence — respect it warmly. Encouraging what they CAN still do themselves is central to good care.

2・Key Vocabulary — 語彙

#	日本語	ROMAJI	ENGLISH	メモ / NOTES
1	お昼 ^{ひる} ごはん	<i>ohirugohan</i>	lunch	
2	時間 ^{じかん}	<i>jikan</i>	time	
3	もう		already	
4	今日 ^{きょう}	<i>kyou</i>	today	
5	魚 ^{さかな}	<i>sakana</i>	fish	
6	仕事 ^{しごと} 日本語 ^{にほんご} · Shigoto Nihongo おいしい		Free video lessons on YouTube · ks-02-meal-assistance delicious	

7	^{め あ} 召し上がる	<i>meshiagaru</i>	to eat/drink (honorific)	
8	ゆっくり		slowly	
9	いただきます		(said before eating)	
10	^{ちゃ} お茶	<i>ocha</i>	tea	
11	むせる		to choke; to cough on food	
12	^き 気をつける	<i>kiotsukeru</i>	to be careful	
13	ありがとう		thanks (casual)	
14	^{なに} 何か	<i>nanika</i>	something; anything	
15	^{てっだ} 手伝う	<i>tetsudau</i>	to help	
16	^{じぶん} 自分	<i>jibun</i>	oneself	
17	^た 食べられる	<i>taberareru</i>	can eat (potential)	

3・Patterns to Reuse — 使える かたち

PATTERN	MEANING & USE
お + [everyday noun]	Polite/soft nouns — お昼[ひる]ごはん, お茶[ちゃ], お水[みず], お魚[さかな]
[adj-stem] + そう	'looks / seems ~' — おいしそう, たのしそう
召[め]し上[あ]がってください	Honorific 'please eat/drink' — for residents & guests
～ないように 気[き]をつけてください	'Please be careful not to ~' — a core safety phrase
何[なに]か ～ましょうか	'Shall I ~ for you?' — offering help politely

Say / write it in Japanese, then check with the answer key.

#	SAY THIS IN JAPANESE	YOUR ANSWER
1	Tell the resident 'It's lunchtime.'	
2	Say politely 'Please take your time and eat.' (honorific)	
3	Warn kindly: 'Please be careful not to choke.'	
4	Offer: 'Shall I help you with anything?'	
5	What is the honorific verb for 食[た]べる (to eat)?	

5・Answer Key — こたえ

1. お昼^{ひる}ごはんの 時間^{じかん}ですよ。
2. ゆっくり 召^めし上^あがってください。
3. むせないように 気^きをつけてください。
4. 何^{なに}か 手^て伝^{つた}いましょうか。
5. 召^めし上^あがる